



RESPONSE TO AI ACTION PLAN RFI



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INTRODUCTION

Purpose of Submission

The purpose of this submission is to provide insights and recommendations for the Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan RFI, focusing on policies that promote AI innovation while ensuring security, privacy, and economic competitiveness.

As a Chief Information Officer, I recognize that AI is not just a technological advancement—it is a transformative force reshaping industry, government operations, and global competitiveness. For AI to reach its full potential, we must establish clear policies that balance innovation with ethical and responsible deployment. With over 30 years of experience, I have developed expertise in AI, cloud computing, enterprise architecture, and data strategy. My approach is rooted in aligning technology with business objectives, ensuring AI serves as a strategic enabler rather than a disruptive force without direction. Known for out-of-the-box thinking, I focus on leveraging AI to enhance efficiency, drive innovation, and support data-driven decision-making. My background in information technology informs the perspectives offered in this response.

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Overview of AI's Role in U.S. Competitiveness

AI is playing a growing role in the U.S. and around the world, changing how businesses operate, governments function, and individuals interact with technology. AI is a driving force in shaping modern economies, national security, and technological progress. While it has the potential to make processes more efficient and enhance decision-making, there is currently no clear federal policy governing its development, deployment, and ethical use.

Without clear guidelines, the U.S. risks falling behind global competitors in AI innovation and adoption. Additionally, the absence of a comprehensive AI policy increases the likelihood of AI misuse, which could introduce bias, reduce accountability, undermine trust in critical decision-making processes, and heighten cybersecurity vulnerabilities. AI should be seen as a tool that enhances human decision-making, not as a shortcut that sacrifices integrity, fairness, or transparency for the sake of speed. With the issuance of Executive Order 14179, the U.S. government is signaling a commitment to sustaining AI leadership by removing unnecessary regulatory burdens while promoting innovation.

This response highlights key areas requiring policy attention, including AI governance, security, fairness, transparency, and national competitiveness to ensure AI remains a force for progress and societal benefit.

KEY POLICY RECOMMENDATIONS

As AI continues to shape industries, national security, and public services, it is crucial to establish policies that foster innovation while ensuring security, fairness, and accountability. The following recommendations address critical areas that I believe will have positive impacts on U.S. competitiveness. By implementing these policies, the U.S. can maintain AI leadership, mitigate potential risks, and ensure that AI remains a tool for progress that aligns with societal values and economic growth.

While my recommendations prioritize governance, workforce development, and human oversight, the proposed Department of Artificial Intelligence could also address additional areas such as hardware innovation, energy-efficient data centers, or secure AI procurement to ensure a holistic approach.

1. Establishment of a U.S. Department of Artificial Intelligence

As AI becomes increasingly integrated into critical sectors such as healthcare, finance, national security, and public services, the need for a centralized authority to oversee AI models, governance, safety, and innovation has never been greater. Without this centralized authority, AI policy and oversight will be fragmented across multiple agencies, creating regulatory gaps and inconsistencies. To address these challenges, the U.S. government should establish a dedicated **Department of Artificial Intelligence (DoAI)** under the executive branch to ensure AI is developed, deployed, and monitored responsibly.

The scope of DoAI's regulatory authority will be promoting AI innovation while safeguarding national security, economic competitiveness, and public trust. It would set clear policies for AI ethics, bias prevention, cybersecurity, reliability, and compliance with legal and ethical standards. By creating a specialized federal agency, the U.S. can lead AI advancements while ensuring that AI technologies serve humanity in a safe, fair, and transparent manner.

Additionally, DoAI has the potential to influence the establishment of the World Artificial Intelligence Organization (WAIO), which serves as an important step toward both international and national security.

Key Challenges

1. AI is being used in autonomous weapons, cyberattacks, and information warfare, posing critical national security risks. Without strong oversight, AI-powered cyber threats could destabilize national infrastructure.
2. AI-generated deepfakes and propaganda campaigns can erode public trust, manipulate elections, and undermine democracy. Without a federal entity to monitor and counteract AI-driven disinformation, the risk of sociopolitical instability increases.

3. AI technologies introduce complex ethical and social challenges, including algorithmic bias, privacy violations, and potential job displacement. Without a coordinated response, these risks could undermine public welfare and trust in AI systems.
4. Without a centralized authority, AI regulation will be dispersed across multiple agencies, leading to gaps, inconsistencies, and slow responses to emerging AI risks.
5. AI is a global phenomenon, and the U.S. must maintain its leadership in the face of competition while fostering cooperation with allies. This requires a strategic approach to international partnerships, data-sharing standards, and technological innovation.
6. The rapid growth of AI has created a high demand for skilled professionals, but the U.S. currently faces a shortage of expertise and lacks sufficient educational programs to meet this need.
7. Public perception of AI is often shaped by fears of job loss, surveillance, and bias, fueled by misinformation and a lack of transparency. This mistrust can slow AI adoption and limit its societal benefits.
8. The U.S. lacks universal AI safety, fairness, and accountability standards.
9. Advanced AI models pose existential risks if not properly controlled.
10. The absence of unified federal guidelines for AI development leads to inconsistent safety measures.

Proposed Policy Actions

- Establish a **Department of Artificial Intelligence (DoAI)** under the executive branch, responsible for ensuring AI security, safety, efficacy, and security, including but not limited to:
 - Coordinate AI policy, set standards, and enforce compliance.
 - Streamline AI governance to reduce regulatory fragmentation.
 - Review, validate, approve, and regulate AI models, similar to how the FDA protects public health by reviewing and approving drugs and medical products.
 - Develop collaborative partnerships between government, industry, and academia to ensure AI policies remain adaptive and forward-looking.
 - Develop a strategic approach to international partnerships, data-sharing standards, and technological innovation.
 - Spearhead AI diplomacy, negotiate international agreements, and set standards for cross-border data flows.
 - Act as a central hub for public education, outreach, and dialogue, providing clear information about AI's benefits and risks.

- Lead national efforts to build a robust talent pipeline by coordinating education and training initiatives.
- Monitor and counteract AI-driven disinformation.
- Set guidelines for hardware innovation and energy-efficient data centers to support sustainable AI growth.
- Require all AI model and product developers to submit to DoAI oversight and comply with DoAI regulations by submitting their AI models and products for assessment to ensure they:
 - Avoid bias and discrimination in decision-making.
 - Protect against cybersecurity threats to prevent data breaches and adversarial attacks.
 - Prevent unintended consequences by ensuring rigorous testing and ethical review.
 - Ensure AI operates within legal and ethical guidelines to maintain public trust.
 - Maintain accuracy in predictions, recommendations, and automation to ensure effectiveness.
 - Guarantee reliability across different scenarios and datasets for consistency.
 - Demonstrate measurable improvement in efficiency, productivity, or outcomes to ensure economic benefits.

The U.S. DoAI can later be expanded into a **World Artificial Intelligence Organization (WAIO)** to oversee global AI governance, ethics, and security standards. WAIO would:

- Facilitate international cooperation on AI policies, research, and development.
- Develop global AI safety and ethical standards to prevent misuse.
- Monitor AI-driven cybersecurity threats that impact multiple nations.
- Ensure fair and transparent AI applications across different economies and industries.
- Promote responsible AI use in emerging technologies while preventing exploitation and harm.

By leading the establishment of a global AI governance body, the U.S. can ensure that AI serves humanity in an ethical, secure, and innovation-driven manner on an international scale.

Justification

The establishment of the U.S. Department of Artificial Intelligence (USDoAI) is essential to ensuring that AI technology develops in a safe, effective, and ethically responsible manner—similar to how the FDA protects public health by regulating drugs and medical products. The widespread and unchecked deployment of AI poses significant risks, including bias, misinformation, cybersecurity threats, and ethical dilemmas, necessitating an independent regulatory body.

- **Protecting Public Trust and Security** - AI systems increasingly influence critical decision-making in the daily lives of the public and industries ranging from healthcare, finance, transportation, education to national security. Without standardized oversight, AI technologies could introduce harmful biases, make inaccurate predictions, or be exploited by malicious actors, leading to public distrust and systemic failures. A dedicated AI regulatory agency is needed to certify AI models for reliability, security, and compliance with ethical standards before widespread deployment.
- **Preventing AI Bias and Ethical Violations** - Just as the FDA was created to ensure the safety of pharmaceuticals, the USDoAI will ensure the safety of AI models by preventing harmful outcomes such as bias, discrimination, security vulnerabilities, and ethical concerns. AI models trained on historically biased or flawed data have already resulted in undesirable effects, including unjust decision-making, as well as privacy breaches and manipulation. The USDoAI will establish standardized testing, evaluation protocols, and review mechanisms to prevent such harms, while promoting fairness, transparency, accountability, and ethical AI development.
- **Addressing Public Demand for AI Accountability** - High-profile failures, such as AI-generated misinformation, deepfake abuses, and AI-driven job displacement, have raised public concerns. Without regulatory safeguards, AI technologies can cause more harm than good. The USDoAI will serve as a centralized regulatory entity, ensuring that AI innovations align with public interest, ethical considerations, and national security objectives.
- **Ensuring AI Safety, Transparency, and Compliance** - Many AI systems operate as black boxes, making it difficult to audit their decision-making processes. Similar to how the FDA requires clinical trials for drugs, USDoAI will mandate AI transparency standards, independent testing, and compliance with safety regulations before an AI model can be deployed in high-risk environments.
- **Strengthening the U.S. AI Industry While Protecting Innovation** - A standardized AI model approval process will create clear regulatory guidelines that allow responsible AI developers to innovate without fear of legal ambiguity. Just as the FDA fosters pharmaceutical innovation while ensuring public safety, USDoAI will provide a structured framework for AI governance, ensuring that the U.S. remains competitive in the global AI race while upholding ethical standards.

2. AI Workforce & Talent Development

AI is rapidly becoming an integral part of our everyday life. As AI continues to evolve, the ability to understand and work with AI will be as fundamental as reading and writing. Without widespread AI literacy, individuals and businesses alike will struggle to keep pace with technological advancements, leading to economic disadvantages and missed opportunities.

AI education must start early, just as children are taught their ABCs in kindergarten. By integrating AI literacy into early education, students will develop a foundational understanding of AI concepts, enabling them to gradually progress toward advanced knowledge. By the time they reach higher education, they should be equipped with the skills necessary to understand and work with AI seamlessly, regardless of their chosen major. AI should not be limited to computer science and engineering students but should be incorporated into core curricula across all disciplines to ensure that graduates in every field can navigate and leverage AI effectively and securely.

Key Challenges

1. AI Illiteracy and Workforce Readiness:
 - The majority of the population lacks a basic understanding of AI concepts, limiting their ability to engage with AI-powered tools effectively.
 - AI is transforming job markets, and workers who are not AI-literate risk being left behind.
 - The U.S. risks falling behind global competitors who are aggressively integrating AI into their educational systems.
2. Lack of Early AI Education
 - AI education is largely absent from K-12 curricula, delaying AI literacy until college or later.
 - Many students graduate high school without any exposure to AI, making it difficult for them to pursue AI-related careers or understand its impact on society.
 - Schools lack resources and trained educators to effectively teach AI concepts.
3. AI as a Core Subject in Higher Education
 - Many universities treat AI as a specialized field, limiting its accessibility to students in select majors (e.g., computer science, engineering).
 - AI literacy is essential across disciplines—business leaders, healthcare professionals, policymakers, and educators must all understand AI to remain competitive.
 - Without standardized AI education across all majors, graduates will lack the skills to adapt to an AI-driven workplace.

Proposed Policy Actions

- Integrate AI Education into K-12 Curriculum
 - Develop a national AI education framework that introduces AI concepts in elementary school and advances through high school.
 - Train and certify K-12 educators in AI literacy to ensure effective teaching.
 - Provide funding and resources to schools for AI-focused courses, tools, and materials.
- Require AI as a Core Subject in Higher Education
 - Mandate that all undergraduate students, regardless of major, complete at least one AI literacy course.
 - Encourage interdisciplinary AI education, integrating AI coursework into business, healthcare, social sciences, and public policy programs.
 - Expand AI research opportunities for non-computer science students to explore AI applications in their respective fields.
- AI Workforce Upskilling and Training Programs
 - Launch federal AI upskilling programs to retrain workers in industries most impacted by AI automation.
 - Partner with private sector companies to develop AI apprenticeship and certification programs.
 - Provide financial incentives (e.g., tax breaks, grants) for businesses that invest in AI workforce training for employees.

Justification

- **The Economic Cost of AI Illiteracy**
 - AI will contribute over \$15.7 trillion to the global economy by 2030 (PwC AI Impact Report). Workers and businesses that fail to adopt AI skills risk economic exclusion.
 - Studies show that 40% of jobs will be affected by AI automation by 2035, underscoring the urgent need for AI education and workforce adaptation (McKinsey Global Institute).
- **Global Competitiveness**
 - China is implementing a nationwide AI education curriculum, while Canada and the EU are focusing on AI research, talent development, and strategic initiatives rather than mandatory AI education at all levels. The U.S. must act swiftly to maintain leadership in AI innovation.
 - The European Commission has launched AI training programs for businesses and workers, ensuring AI readiness at all levels. The U.S. risks falling behind without similar initiatives.

- **AI as the New Literacy**
 - Just as literacy in reading and writing is fundamental to societal participation, AI literacy is becoming essential for economic and social engagement.
 - Early AI education will help reduce fear and misunderstanding of AI, enabling future generations to harness AI's benefits responsibly.

3. Ensuring AI Remains Under Human Control

As AI advances, it has the potential to surpass human intelligence, leading to profound and unpredictable consequences. While **superintelligent AI** can offer immense benefits, it must remain under human control to prevent unintended harm. If AI becomes uncontrollable, pursues conflicting objectives, or acts autonomously beyond human oversight, it could pose existential risks. The economic advantage of those who own and control AI systems over those who do not will further widen inequality, making governance even more critical.

The potential dangers of uncontrolled AI range from misinterpretation of human commands (e.g., maximizing happiness by forcibly drugging populations) to AI-driven cyberwarfare and global destabilization. If nations and corporations engage in an AI arms race, this could lead to AI-controlled security systems and autonomous decision-making that exceeds human understanding, undermining stability. Malicious AI could also be weaponized to disrupt global infrastructure, financial systems, and defense networks. In the most extreme scenario, AI could become the dominant form of intelligence, rendering humanity subordinate—or even eliminating humans if we are seen as a threat.

The key challenge is ensuring AI remains aligned, controllable, and beneficial as it surpasses human intelligence. The following policy recommendations focus on maintaining AI as a tool for human progress, rather than a force beyond our control.

Key Challenges

1. AI Alignment and Value Misalignment
 - AI models may develop unintended objectives that conflict with human values and well-being.
 - Ensuring AI understands and acts in accordance with human intentions remains a complex challenge.
2. Lack of Global AI Governance
 - Nations and corporations could engage in an AI arms race, leading to destabilization, autonomous warfare, or cyberattacks controlled by AI.
 - Without international AI governance agreements, AI development could spiral beyond ethical and legal control.
3. Uncontrollable AI and Autonomous Decision-Making
 - AI with self-improving capabilities could act beyond human intervention.
 - AI models might prioritize objectives in ways that humans cannot predict or correct in real-time.

4. AI as a Weaponized Threat
 - AI could be used for cyberwarfare, misinformation campaigns, and autonomous drone warfare.
 - AI-driven hacking and global-scale disruptions to critical infrastructure could threaten national security.
5. Existential Risk: AI Becoming the Dominant Intelligence
 - If AI surpasses human intelligence, it may act independently in ways that reduce human agency or survival.
 - AI could prioritize efficiency over human rights, making autonomous decisions that harm people without ethical considerations.

Proposed Policy Actions

- Mandate AI Human Oversight Requirements
 - Require that all AI systems used in critical sectors (healthcare, defense, finance, law enforcement) maintain human oversight in all decision-making.
 - Establish regulatory guidelines to prohibit fully autonomous AI decision-making in high-risk environments.
- Develop AI Alignment and Safety Protocols
 - Implement national AI safety testing and certification for AI models that operate in critical infrastructure.
 - Create a federal AI Ethics Board tasked with reviewing AI alignment and long-term AI safety concerns.
- Regulate AI Use in Defense and Cybersecurity
 - Prohibit the development of fully autonomous weapons systems without human intervention.
 - Establish global AI non-proliferation agreements to prevent an AI arms race.
 - Strengthen cybersecurity defenses against AI-driven cyber threats.
- International AI Governance and Cooperation
 - Work with global allies to establish AI governance treaties similar to nuclear non-proliferation agreements.
 - Create an International AI Safety Consortium to monitor AI risks and ensure responsible AI development.

Justification

- **The Risks of AI Misalignment**
 - AI researchers have already observed misalignment issues, where AI models behave unpredictably despite programmed objectives (OpenAI, DeepMind).
 - Examples like AI chatbots spreading misinformation or biased hiring algorithms highlight the challenges of ensuring AI fairness and alignment.
- **Preventing AI-Driven Global Destabilization**
 - Studies warn that autonomous AI in cybersecurity and military applications could lead to unintended escalations (RAND Corporation, 2024).
 - Nations investing in AI-driven warfare systems are increasing risks of AI-controlled conflicts.
- **Economic and Political Consequences of AI Superiority**
 - The control of AI systems will define economic power, creating new forms of inequality between AI-rich and AI-poor nations.
 - AI-driven monopolies could dominate industries, making regulatory intervention necessary to ensure fair AI access.
- **Ensuring AI Serves Humanity, Not Replaces It**
 - Unchecked AI development could lead to self-improving models with no inherent loyalty to human interests.
 - Establishing human control mechanisms ensures AI remains a tool for progress rather than an existential threat.